26-27 Issue I

THE GOVERNOR

The New and Improved Weight Room

PARKER BAKER '27

If you've been to the weight room this year, you might notice it looks very different from previous years. Over the summer, the weight room has undergone some changes, both to the room itself and to the programs that take place. Leading these changes is the new Strength and Conditioning coach, Ms. O'Connell, known as Coach KK, class of 2021.

One of the biggest changes to the weight room has been the new equipment and layout. The bottom floor of the weight room has been rearranged and now contains all the squat racks and lifting equipment, while the second floor contains treadmills and bikes. In an interview with Coach KK, she said: "This makes the weight room more functional and can have a better flow when there are large groups of people." In addition, the weight room has added a lot of new equipment, such as three new trap bars, barbells from Merrimack College, resistance bands, and minibands.

Another big change is the new and improved strength and conditioning afternoon program. Unlike previous years, when the program was just open gym time, this year it is more structured. Athletes in the program train together, split into two groups—intro and advanced—with three lifting sessions a week and two speed and agility sessions. Coach KK said, "Having structured programming that allows students to progress throughout the 9-10 weeks can make them stronger and better prepared for their upcoming seasons." This afternoon program is open to all sophomores, juniors, and seniors.

Coach KK has also been helping varsity teams with team lifts. In an interview with girls varsity soccer captain Hannah Babo '27, she described mobility work and four sets of different exercises. The time in the weight room is only thirty minutes; however, Hannah said, "It will help us get faster and get stronger, and it's a very quick 30 minutes. It's very efficient, and Coach KK definitely helps us get better."

Another priority in the weight room is keeping the space clean and well maintained. In past years, the weight room has been left a mess; however, Coach KK plans on enforcing expectations by "holding people accountable who don't follow the rules." Additionally, Coach KK said, "If we don't clean up our space, then we can't use the weight room — but reminders do go a long way."

Over the summer, Coach KK has put a substantial amount of time and effort into changing the weight room and creating a new strength program. Her goal for the year is to "have everyone have a chance to learn a little bit more about exercising and find time to enjoy it."



Coach KK, class of 2021

New Policy on Cellphones

GAVIN ANDERSON '28

After a brutal math class where it seems as though the teacher is speaking another language and a cold science class out in the marsh by Alfond, all students want to do is relax in the dining hall with their friends and check their phones for texts, emails, fantasy football scores, or social media. However, students must remind themselves that phones can't be visible in the dining hall. Do cell phones make our generation more "brainrotted" and worse at creating conversations? Or, can we use them appropriately to relax while still connecting with the community?

This school year, students are prohibited from having their phone visible in the dining hall from 11 am to 1 pm. Mr. Delay said that "Having no phones allows for social interaction and more personal conversation." While there's no doubt that this is true and lunch is an amazing opportunity for making a friend, so much of what we do in this generation is on our phones and it doesn't stop people from making conversation or meeting a new classmate. Connecting with others can involve taking a phone out to get someone's snapchat or instagram. Ty Harrington '29 argues that "Simply talking about stuff on your phone could be a conversation starter."

The idea of no phones during this time isn't an unbearable burden to students, but they would still like to check it for quick reassurance so that they aren't missing out on what's going on in the world or with their friends and family. We're nervous of our phones getting taken away when we simply want to check the time. Cole Travaglini '29 says "What if I need to see if a teacher has changed a meeting time?"

Cole Cournoyer '28 argues that phones don't need to be fully allowed but a simple glance, text, email, or quick check should be allowed. "But sitting there scrolling, not interacting with people should not be allowed."

My simple, and easy solution is that phones should only be used for a quick check or a glance for the time while we are eating lunch. Perhaps teachers could ease up slightly on the taking of cell phones in the dining hall. But students who are sitting there and not interacting with peers should be reminded to put it away. Let's embrace what's a part of our generation, while also being present in our beautiful community.



Follow for updates this year!

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From the Editors: Buzzing First Week Back!

NICHOLAS ZHUO '27, LORELAI BLUME '27, BEN DAHLSTEDT '27, LANA HARDIN '27

Full of preseason practices, orientation activities, and new faces arriving on campus, the first weeks back from summer break are meant to bring the school together and kick off the school year. These weeks were buzzing with excitement for the year ahead!

Unity Day has always been a keystone event at the start of the school year. It is a day to connect with peers, enjoy a unique location, and tackle challenges with an adventurous spirit. The freshmen visited Newburyport, rode a boat, and bonded in the ocean breeze. The sophomores geared up at Take Flight in Kittery and took on three different rope courses. The juniors trod Mt. Agamenticus, leaving footprints on dirt paths and in the shade of trees; they pushed towards the summit with both strong mental and physical stamina. Seniors headed south to the Ipswich River and kayaked 9.7 chaotic but fun miles; they all came back exhausted and sunburned, but the day was full of laughter and pride.

Square Dance on Friday was PACKED! Students across all four grades showed out to the Rink parking lot to do-si-do and promenade their hearts out. Students jumped, danced, and ran frantically in circles to old-timey folk songs, even tapping into their childhood roots with the classic Cotton-Eye Joe routine.

On Saturday night, Porter Field was blown up with several inflatables courtesy of Ms. Gargano. These inflatable games included an obstacle course, fighting area, Velcro jumpsuits and a Velcro wall (imagine what happened there), and more! It was an opportunity to watch students smash into inflatable objects and absolutely eat dirt, and it was hilarious. Both square dancing and inflatables were major successes, and students are already looking forward to their return next year!

Our first official day back included familiar and new faces, all dressed up. Some say we should wear formal dress more often, while others say we shouldn't wear it at all. What do you think? The week began with our first real day of classes and ended with the Dummer Cup. Ingham has the lead in points so far. You can hear more about the Dummer Cup in Owen's article on the next page, where he speaks with students and faculty about how great last Friday night was.

Tuesday was particularly fun for the seniors; they departed from campus for Senior Sunrise. Arriving at 5:50 a.m., they made it to the beach just in time. StuCo made great photo frames, the deans provided donuts, and there was plenty of good company. They enjoyed taking photos, hanging out with friends, and watching the sun turn orange. One could say it couldn't have been better, but every bus wanted to stop at Dunkin on the way back!

This action-packed opening week of school set a high-energy tone, promising a great school year ahead. Welcome back, Govs!!

New Teacher, New Perspective

MAROFA '28

This year, the Govs community welcomes Mr. Caleb Adams, who has joined the Math department. Mr. Adams teaches Honors Geometry and Honors Algebra 2 and coaches JV Girls Soccer and Varsity Girls Tennis. While he now teaches and coaches at Govs, his career began in a very different setting.

Prior to becoming a teacher, Mr. Adams was a federal consultant working in data analytics and federal credit. His experience with math and data eventually paved the way for his career as an educator, allowing him to bring this unique skill set into the classroom. He later began teaching at Brimmer and May, a day school in Chestnut Hill, MA.

So, what exactly brought him to Govs? For Mr. Adams, the community is a significant part of his interest in Govs: "Govs is such a wonderful community of supportive and collaborative people." Whether it's academics and sports or the weekend activities, he says Govs "feels like home."

He is also surprised by how many areas students excel in and is impressed by how engaged they are in a variety of activities throughout the day.

One of the things Mr. Adams most enjoys teaching is how "versatile math methods are across the disciplines". Mr. Adams sees math as playing a significant role in fields such as statistics, history, anthropology, biology, engineering, and many more. When teaching math, he says, "I am able to make a meaningful impact and help guide students towards discovering their own passions." For him, math is not limited to equations and numbers in the classroom; it can be a useful tool across many different areas of education.

Outside of the classroom, Mr. Adams has some interests that students may not expect! He used to volunteer with a dog rescue, and his family has adopted several failed fosters that they decided to keep. He enjoys playing tennis. Besides playing tennis, he also enjoys playing volleyball, card and board games, watching Jeopardy, and traveling.

From math to tennis to traveling, Mr. Adams seems to have mastered many talents, but he is still working on one skill: cooking. As he puts it, "Someday I'll figure out how to be a better cook too."



Mr. Adams



Preview of Next Page

Jakob Witt '28 and Jerry Zhang '27 fighting for the win of Musical Chairs at the Dummer Cup



Dumber & G-Dawg Issue 1 by Lana Hardin '27

The Staff Art Show

VIV BLAKE '27

If you walked into the Remis Art Gallery in Wilkie on Friday, September 18th, you would be greeted by many members of the Govs community coming together to appreciate art submissions from staff across campus. Dr. O's beautiful violin music fills the room, and you see an assortment of amazing art from staff across campus. Photography, paintings, sculptures, and even embroidery pieces cover the walls and stand on tables around the room.

The Staff Art Show gave us a unique opportunity to see the different talents of many Govs staff members. The teachers in the art department, as well as the Kaiser proctors, worked to provide a platform for anyone on the staff to show off their creativity. Kaiser proctor Lana Hardin '27 said she believed the event was worthwhile: "I think it really represents how tight of a community we have here at Govs." Ms. Fitz, another organizer of the art show, said: "It was great to see everyone coming to appreciate what all the artists created." She hopes to have more staff featured in the future.

From Ms. Roberto's expressive charcoal portraits to Mr. Ogden's reluctantly submitted poems, the show featured a wide variety of creations and creators. The art show gave the students a chance to see things the staff do outside of work. One thing that really grabbed my interest was Mr. Woodruff's (head of facilities) handmade skateboards. He made wooden skateboards with each of his kids: one with blue wheels and dark brown wood stripes, and another with green wheels and pink-hued wood stripes down the front.

Another piece that stood out to me was Ms. Docks' quilt. It had thirty squares, each sewn with a different woodland animal and fabric. My personal favorite animals were the beavers, whose teeth were very cute, but there were many others, including bears, foxes, raccoons, and deer. The square in the center said "Docks" and was stitched over a few colorful mushrooms. It was a great night to showcase the true talent of employees from around campus.

The Staff Art Show was an amazing chance for the Govs community to see a different side of the people who make this place what it is. With so many unique talents on display, the evening was a great reminder that there is always more to know about the people around us.











Dummer Cup 2026!

OWEN DENIO '27

The Dummer Cup is one of the most attended weekend events at Govs every year. From the spikeball tournament to the three-legged race, I saw strong participation, representation from every grade, and great turnout from all dorms and day student teams.

Gezi Nkugwa '27 compared this year's Dummer Cup energy to last year. "It was better this year, especially in Perkins; I think we had the whole dorm participate." In just four years, the event has become one of Govs' main traditions. Gezi said, "Personally, I think it is a super fun tradition, and I like competing with other dorms." Dummer Cup is fun for the school community because it brings out students' competitive spirit in productive ways.

One of the best moments in the Dummer Cup comes at the start of the event, when all the dorms converge in the field house parking lot. It's fun to see all the dorms' banner themes and get hyped together as a community. When all the dorms came together, you could see our school's competitive nature. Everyone pretended to be enemies to win every event.

This year's Dummer Cup certainly felt like it had better energy than last year. Competitions included wall sitting, spikeball, bagbiting, musical chairs (see picture on page 6), and other categories, and all of these activities helped build a positive vibe and a strong community at Govs. Win or lose, I saw students having fun at every event.

Events like the Dummer Cup are very positive for the school community. The more people participate, the closer we get as a school, and the more fun we all have at events like this. I am excited for future weekend events like the black box dances, and I hope students will come out and join the fun!

No Days Off: How Govs Football is Turning The Program Around

CHASE KRUSKO '27

After a rough 0-8 season last year, the Governor's Academy football team is already showing major signs of improvement this fall. After an exciting scrimmage win over Brooks, the team aims to build on that performance and keep dominating the challenging ISL competition. With many recruits and a new approach to game-time preparation, the Govs football team hopes to succeed this season.

Many players have given positive feedback about the new practice and film schedule. Coach Gardner Cousins '20 said that "allowing the players to watch the film together and then dissect each play on the whiteboard has allowed the team to translate more of what they learn from film onto the field." The team plans to build on the established gritty culture that has led to past success.

New recruits like Wyatt Ayers '29, Jakob Witt '28, Chase Dowling '28, Jaden Wilbon '29, and Brayden Fowler '28 have helped the football program improve tremendously. As additions to the D-line, linebacker core, and defensive back group, these new recruits have already demonstrated an immediate impact on the program.

Captain Owen Denio '27 said, "The biggest thing that's going to be different is the attitude around every game and practice. We've been coming out with a lot of energy, and it seems to be a better overall vibe on the team, and it seems like more of a brotherhood as opposed to last year."

These new recruits have impacted Govs football on the field, and their commitment to the team and the leadership they bring has also reinforced the program's culture. Brandon Hennessey '27 said "I think that being a community where we all see each other as equal and we don't have one person thinking that they're all that means something to the team". All in all there is a lot of excitement around the Govs football program this year, and with students and parents eager to see the results of these changes.

This week the Governors will get another chance to demonstrate their talents against Middlesex in which players like Owen Denio '27, Brandon Hennessey '27, and Tyler Kasztejna '28 are expected to dominate and lead the Governors to a big win. Overall the team seems more complete and more united than ever before and we're all excited to see how this year's Governors football team will perform.



Highlights

Porter Lalime '27, who also happens to be a member of The Governor 2026 staff!

New Policy on Absences

CLARA STEFFEN '27

A missed class can happen for many reasons, whether a student oversleeps, has a family emergency, struggles with a mental health issue, or simply forgets an assignment or deadline and does not want to deal with it. With the first month of school already behind them, students are adjusting to the new attendance rules designed to make skipping class harder to get away with. The policy has sparked questions about how the school should balance student accountability with the understanding that some significant reason could be behind a missed class.

Under the new policy created by the dean's team, consequences increase with each unexcused absence. One unexcused absence leads to a Friday night study hall. A second unexcused absence results in a longer Friday night study hall, and three unexcused absences result in "clipboarding." According to Ms. Gargano, "clipboarding" means checking in on campus on Sunday from 9am to 7pm, signing a sheet every hour to show they are present. Both day students and boarders are expected to follow the same Sunday schedule.

The change in rules is meant to make missed classes and the consequences harder to ignore. Mrs. Kingsbury explained the reasoning behind the change: "Every hour a student misses, they owe us back an hour." Her comment shows that class time is valuable and that students should take responsibility for what they miss. Teachers are frustrated with the lack of consequences for multiple absences.

Last year, students seemed to take advantage of the fact that three unexcused absences equaled a Friday night study hall. Students would use two of those three unexcused absences to skip a class if they wanted, avoiding accountability. Mrs. Kingsbury said the new rules bring a different kind of responsibility for staff, but not necessarily more work. Instead, she described it as "different levels of commitment to enforce things."

Some students feel that the policy does not leave enough room before they immediately get in trouble. Ayla Cifric '27 and Grace Fyrberg '27 said, "We don't particularly think that is fair." They would prefer a two-strike system. A first absence would serve as their one and only warning, with a Friday night study hall following the second unexcused absence. Their idea would still hold students accountable for missing class while giving them an opportunity to learn from their mistake before facing their punishment.

Although the policy is designed to make skipping harder, its success may depend on whether students feel the consequences are fair. As the year continues, the school will have to see if a stricter punishment will actually change student behavior or simply create a new set of concerns.

Teachers & Their Summer Breaks

DK RHEE '28

Many students may think that teachers do not live interesting lives during summer break. However, teachers have their own hobbies, trips, and other jobs, and they spend time preparing for the next school year. Mr. Ogden and Mrs. Borgatti both spent their summer breaks both traveling and preparing for the next school year.

Mr. Ogden traveled to Korea and China during the summer, where he met some of his former students and their families, giving him a chance to reconnect with students he had taught in the past. The trip allowed him to experience a whole new part of the world while making strong connections through their shared love of golf.

He also played golf and participated in a golf tournament with his brother. This was especially meaningful for him because Mr. Ogden's brother had been dealing with a health problem and had undergone a bilateral lung transplant. For Mr. Ogden, winning a tournament mattered less than simply being able to spend time with his brother.

Mr. Ogden said, "I have won tournaments before, and that's always fun. But the real victory, the meaningful win -- being able to spend time together. Lots of players came by after the tournament to congratulate us, and what they all said or suggested was that just being there and being together was a win! And they were happy to be a part of it."

Mrs. Borgatti also spent a lot of her summer doing outdoor activities. She led people on trail rides in Vermont and also spent time mountain biking. The highlight of her summer came when she traveled to Alaska and stayed on the Kenai Peninsula for about ten days. She went fishing and horseback riding, and also came face-to-face with a grizzly bear. She caught fish during the trip and sent some of the fresh fish home.

These summer activities connected to what she teaches at Govs. As an Environmental Science teacher, she looks for things in nature that she can later use in her class. For example, she took pictures of sights during her trips to use when she teaches. For her, preparation for her classes does not get a vacation! Ms. Borgatti said that she also worked as a consultant outside of Govs in Vermont. As she suggested, many Govs teachers work jobs and continue to learn during their summers.

Mr. Ogden and Mrs. Borgatti show that summer break is not only a time when teachers take a break from school. It is also a time when teachers can recharge, have new experiences, and prepare themselves before returning to school.





The Animal Kingdom

PORTER LALIME '27



Govs campus is home to some unusual pets, including Mrs. McLain's pig Haru, and Mrs. Borgatti's litter of puppies. Sixteen years ago, an unusual request to babysit a pig became a large addition to Mr. and Mrs. McLain's family. Mrs. Borgatti helps to breed dogs and often has a bunch of puppies running around. Both the pig and puppies provide good stories and bring a sense of life to campus.

The special name of Mrs. McLain's pig comes from, "Haru, the great white ninja of whom the prophecies speak of," a quote from the 1997 martial arts comedy film *Beverly Hills Ninja.* When her daughter was a senior at Bowdoin, she asked her parents to babysit the pig during March break. The pig came to Byfield for two weeks and was then sent back to college. Not long after, he was back at Govs because, "it's really hard to keep an illegal pig in the dorms at a college."

Haru has a rigorous schedule of sleeping and belly rubs. He is old now so he is not as active, but Mrs. McLain said, "when he was little he would wander across the turf looking for apples under the wild trees." He also enjoys the fireplace. A fun fact about pigs is that they don't sweat, contradicting the common misconception that they smell. According to Mrs. McLain, they are very clean animals.

It's much more common to find someone with a dog or two instead of a pig, but Mrs. Borgatti goes beyond the expected; instead of one or two dogs, she has raised nine puppies. Mrs. Borgatti works with a breeder and takes care of litters of puppies that will grow up to be in working homes in search and rescue, medical alert, therapy, and hunting careers. She said "It's a good thing they are cute, because they are high maintenance." She needs to sleep near the pups for the first couple weeks so they don't wander off or get cold during the night. Puppies can't see or hear for the first 14 days, and she also has to make sure they get enough calcium while they are young. As they grow older, the puppies need to be fed every 2-3 hours to ensure their growth, making it hard for Mrs. Borgatti to be gone for too long.

Mrs. Borgatti shared a story of a pup who kept roaming freely around the house and mysteriously escaped her "gated community" frequently. She was confused how she got free while the others were still in the gated area. Mrs. Borgatti happened to come home right when the puppy was scaling the fence to escape while all the other puppies just watched.

These pets provide a sense of home to the school community. Though the boarders have to leave their pets to come to Govs, they can still have connections to animals on campus.



Three Activity Controversy: Is the Rule Outdated?

TEDDY WHIPPLE '27

Is the three-activity rule outdated at Govs? Many of us ask that question because we have been forced to do a sport or activity we didn't want in the first place. However, it has also allowed students to try new activities and engage in life on campus.

At the academy, all students must participate in one sport or activity each season. For example, I play football in the fall, strength and conditioning during the winter, then lacrosse in the spring. However, freshmen and sophomores must play a sport or participate in the arts and cannot do activities like strength/conditioning until they are upperclassmen.

I asked Mrs. Barcomb, the athletic director at Govs, about the origin and intentions of the rule. She explained that, as a boarding school, the requirement was created to keep students engaged and on campus.

When this rule was introduced, out-of-school commitments weren't as common, especially before COVID: "It [COVID] definitely changed the dynamic of athletes regularly doing three sports, as it was much more common to see that, unlike today," she said.

I also asked Mrs. Barcomb about whether she would change this rule. She said, "With the right support and figuring out what to do with kids while they have a season off, this could be a possibility in the future for maybe seniors to only have to do two seasons." Her biggest concern was for underclassmen boarding students having nothing to do once the school day concluded. She said it "defeats the purpose of the structure that boarding schools are supposed to have."

Boarding student Porter LaLime '27, a football and baseball player, said, "I understand the idea of it, but most people would agree that they want a season off." Porter felt that giving students more options would be useful. He especially wanted "to make an independent activity more of an availability here."

At my old school, you were allowed to participate in an independent activity, where you signed off on your own activity and were excused from afternoon programs. This allowed students to pursue an out-of-school commitment like a club sport or another activity not affiliated with their school.

Porter agreed with this approach, saying, "In the past I'd use the winter to train for baseball, but with the rule, it took my time away to train in the off-season."

The three-activity rule at Govs is a hotly debated topic as it serves benefits but also has downsides. It works because it keeps students engaged on campus, busy, and able to try new activities. On the flip side, it can take away an important off-season for athletes or force students into activities they don't want.

How long can the school hang on to this policy in the world of club sports and outside commitments?

A Failed Policy: Nametags at Govs

HANNAH BABO '27

For the past two weeks, students across Govs were asked to wear name tags around campus. However, not all students followed the request. The tags were meant to make it easier for students, faculty, and other members of the Govs community to identify one another, especially as new faculty joined the school. While the request had a clear purpose, students' reactions raised questions about how effective the initiative was.

The Dean's team introduced the name tags to help members of the community learn each other's names and encourage more interaction. The decision was partly influenced by the number of new faculty members joining campus. Ms. Gargano explained there was a "good mix of both" goals: helping people learn names and encouraging members of the community to know one another. For a school where students and faculty interact throughout the day, knowing someone's name can make approaching them easier. Instead of having to ask someone's name, students could simply look at their tag.

However, some students were reluctant to follow the request. Sienna Mercaldi '27 said she did not think students took the name tags as seriously as teachers expected.

"I haven't worn a name tag since elementary school," Sienna said, explaining that she viewed the requirement as something that did not fit naturally into a high school environment.

Another concern was the physical size of the name tags. Mr. Nelson pointed out that the name tags were very small, making the names difficult to see from far away. If one of the main purposes of the initiative was to make it easier for people to identify one another, the size of the tags could limit how useful they actually were.

Rather than abandoning the goal of creating a welcoming community, Govs could consider other ways to encourage everyone to get to know one another.

Activities that bring together different grades and faculty could create opportunities for people to introduce themselves, such as having more Unity Days or combining advisories with other groups.

Another option could be a peer leadership program, where groups of 10-15 underclassmen are assigned an older student who can help them adjust to campus and answer questions.

Ms. Gargano suggested that the school could try "a different way that is more appealing" in the future. Finding a more natural approach could also still accomplish the school's goal while making students more willing to participate.

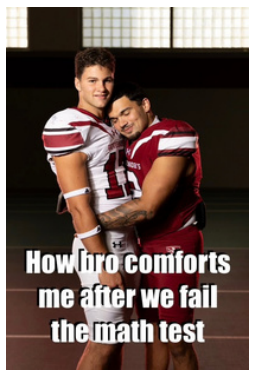
The Governor Word Search 1 26-27 Season

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DAY
KAISER
PARSONS
WILKIE
MARSH
FROST







Govs vs. Brooks RIVALRY

EMERSON BYRNE '27

Almost all Govs students are familiar with our rivalry with Brooks. However, where does that rivalry come from? The Govs-Brooks rivalry is a century old, and the school should make an effort to keep the rivalry vibrant in the years to come.

According to a past *Governor* article from 2010, it states that the first time the two schools played each other was in a hockey game on December 18, 1931. This was only five years after Brooks had been founded in 1926. So how could a school that was founded in 1926 compete so fiercely with our 1763 founding? And who did we compete with before then?

Mrs. Slater, the school historian, shared that originally our rival was Belmont Hill. However, when Govs became co-ed in 1971, it became clear that it would no longer make sense to have our rival be an all-boys school. Peter Bragdon, former head of school and Brooks faculty kid, decided that Brooks would be the new major rival.

The 2010 Governor article also said that Govs and Brooks didn't originally play each other in football as they feared the schools would only play pranks on one another. However, after the ISL formed in 1948, Brooks became a regular on the teams' schedules.

The relationship between Govs and Brooks involves school spirit, traditions, and a sense of fun that only students can bring. Some of those early traditions were certainly more extreme than what we see today. Govs students used to burn mannequins dressed in Brooks apparel to signify Govs students' superiority over Brooks students — both academically and athletically. Another tradition involves an athletic competition between the two schools where the losing team would fly the flag of the opposing school that had won. Additionally, students have involved Brooks in many senior pranks, like putting Govs merch all over their school.

The reason the Govs-Brooks rivalry has lasted so long is simple: proximity. Unlike a school like St. Georges, Brooks is close enough to feel like a constant competitor. The two schools are only 11.3 miles apart, and outside of sports, they compete for similar incoming students. They are both boarding schools in northern Massachusetts that prioritize athletics, small class sizes, and a close-knit community.

As of now, the rivalry between Govs and Brooks feels as though it is a low point. We have lost a lot of previous traditions and playing them in sports almost feels like playing any other school.

"Rivalries really encourage school spirit," said Mrs. Slater. There are bigger crowds at sports games and events. Rivalries are beneficial to sports culture, but they also help to bring a community together. It makes students proud of their school and what they can accomplish.

New Doors on Campus

DYLAN POTVIN '28

With this year's new door-locking system, I have witnessed teachers and students stuck behind doors and unable to get through at times of day when punctuality is key. With all the new rules and regulations around campus, adding more factors for being late to class isn't ideal for students trying to succeed. But the door system is a necessary new reality. Maybe the problem doesn't lie in the new system but in people who are scared of change.

As summer closed, students and faculty returned to campus and a whole new way of navigating the door entries for the buildings. Our Student IDs no longer allow us into buildings; it is a new app on our phones that lets us tap to open doors. Although a new app and new technology sounds fantastic for a school that's been around since the 1700s, it has its upsides and downsides.

The new app allows the school to have more control over access to the buildings in order to keep the campus secure. Mr. McGonagill explains, "Change can be scary, but from a security standpoint, the improved technology will definitely benefit the community in the long run."

On the other side, Drew Giguere, '27, believes that the new app "takes away a sense of privacy because it tracks you wherever you are going." From a student perspective, the app could make us feel like we are being monitored too closely and eliminate any sense of freedom we had before. But it allows the school to know where we are at all times and to lock down the buildings when there is a threat to campus. For new students, this added to the challenge of learning their way around a new campus.

Cole Cournoyer '28 said, "It's definitely hard to get into buildings, especially transitioning from my old school. Sometimes my phone is dead, or I'm by myself and the system is having trouble while I'm trying to get into the dorm or buildings. It can be frustrating having to wait or figuring it out." Govs is trying to encourage us to be less dependent on our phones, but needing them on standby at all times contradicts this idea.

There are certainly both positive and negative views of the new door lock system. The app's functionality definitely needs work, as it has glitches. The Govs community just needs to adjust to the change because the app's intentions are good. The minor glitches that make the student body uncomfortable will be fixed in the future, and we will all benefit from a safer environment.





MAD LIB

On a bright and glorious day _____ (day of the week), you're challenged to bring a(n) _____ (animal native to the Amazon) into _____ (a dorm). However, when you're walking around with this creature, _____ (a teacher) stops you. "What's that in your hands?" they ask. You don't really know how to tell him you that your friends are recreating _____ (a famous movie) out of animals from the Amazon. So you tell him you're doing _____ (a type of science experiment). You are kicked out of Govs for this _____ (adjective) behavior, and transferred to _____ (cold country).

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